LOCAL GOVERNANCE AND SERVICE DELIVERY

THREE LEGS OF DEVOLUTION → TWO CONSTITUTIONAL FUNCTIONAL DOMAINS → FROM LISTED SUBJECT TO → FISCAL ARCHITECTURE CARD → PLANNING INSTITUTIONS → SCHEDULED AREAS PRECISION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g1 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 — THREE LEGS OF DEVOLUTION

THREE LEGS OF DEVOLUTION · OWN-SOURCE REVENUE PLUS PREDICTABLE, FORMULA-BASED TRANSFERS · SUBJECTS ACTUALLY TRANSFERRED IN PRACTICE, NOT MERELY LISTED IN · STAFF CONTROLLED BY AND ANSWERABLE TO THE LOCAL BODY · WITHOUT ALL THREE TOGETHER, CONSTITUTIONAL STATUS EXISTS WITHOUT DELIVERY · MUST REMEMBER · LOCAL GOVERNANCE LINKS CONSTITUTIONAL DEVOLUTION, STATE LEGISLATION

FUNDS → own-source revenue plus predictable, formula-based transfers → FUNCTIONS → subjects actually transferred in practice, not merely listed in State law → FUNCTIONARIES → staff controlled by and answerable to the local body, not only deputed → RULE → without all three together, constitutional status exists without delivery capacity → MUST REMEMBER: Local governance links constitutional devolution, state legislation

CORE CLAIM
- FUNDS → own-source revenue plus predictable, formula-based transfers
- FUNCTIONS → subjects actually transferred in practice, not merely listed in State law

MECHANISM
- FUNCTIONARIES → staff controlled by and answerable to the local body; not only deputed
- RULE → without all three together, constitutional status exists without delivery capacity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Local governance links constitutional devolution, state legislation,...
- FUNDS → own-source revenue plus predictable, formula-based transfers

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → without all three together, constitutional status exists without delivery capacity.

01

STAGE 01 — TWO CONSTITUTIONAL FUNCTIONAL DOMAINS

TWO CONSTITUTIONAL FUNCTIONAL DOMAINS · ARTICLE 243G WITH THE ELEVENTH SCHEDULE; TWENTY-NINE LISTED SUBJECTS · THE TWELFTH SCHEDULE; EIGHTEEN MUNICIPAL FUNCTIONS · URBAN LIST INCLUDES · PLANNING, LAND USE, WATER, SANITATION, SOLID WASTE, PUBLIC HEALTH · SHARED LIMIT · A LISTED FUNCTION IS NOT PROOF OF BUDGET, STAFF

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RURAL → Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule; twenty-nine listed subjects	URBAN LIST INCLUDES → planning, land use, water, sanitation, solid waste, public health	RURAL → Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule; twenty-nine listed subjects
URBAN → the Twelfth Schedule; eighteen municipal functions	SHARED LIMIT → a listed function is not proof of budget, staff or agency control	URBAN → the Twelfth Schedule; eighteen municipal functions

CORE CLAIM
- RURAL → Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule; twenty-nine listed subjects
- URBAN → the Twelfth Schedule; eighteen municipal functions

MECHANISM
- URBAN LIST INCLUDES → planning, land use, water, sanitation, solid waste, public health
- SHARED LIMIT → a listed function is not proof of budget, staff or agency control

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RURAL → Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule; twenty-nine listed subjects
- URBAN → the Twelfth Schedule; eighteen municipal functions

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SHARED LIMIT → a listed function is not proof of budget, staff or agency control.

02

STAGE 02 — FROM LISTED SUBJECT TO REAL CONTROL

FROM LISTED SUBJECT TO REAL CONTROL · LISTED IN THE SCHEDULE · THE ENABLING CONSTITUTIONAL FRAME ONLY · STATE LAW · WHICH SUBJECTS THE STATE ACT ACTUALLY TRANSFERS · ACTIVITY MAPPING · WHICH ACTIVITY WITHIN A SUBJECT GOES TO WHICH TIER · FUND AND FUNCTIONARY TRANSFER

LISTED IN THE SCHEDULE → the enabling constitutional frame only → STATE LAW: which subjects the State Act actually transfers → ACTIVITY MAPPING: which activity within a subject goes to which tier → FUND AND FUNCTIONARY TRANSFER: the step most often missing → WORK-ORDER TEST: who holds the budget line and signs the work order

CORE CLAIM
- LISTED IN THE SCHEDULE → the enabling constitutional frame only
- STATE LAW: which subjects the State Act actually transfers

MECHANISM
- ACTIVITY MAPPING: which activity within a subject goes to which tier
- FUND AND FUNCTIONARY TRANSFER: the step most often missing

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- WORK-ORDER TEST: who holds the budget line and signs the work order
- LISTED IN THE SCHEDULE → the enabling constitutional frame only

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WORK-ORDER TEST: who holds the budget line and signs the work order.

03

STAGE 03 — FISCAL ARCHITECTURE CARD

FISCAL ARCHITECTURE CARD · OWN REVENUE · PROPERTY TAX AND LOCAL LEVIES: NARROW BASE, OUTDATED VALUATION · STATE FINANCE COMMISSION · RECOMMENDS DEVOLUTION OF STATE REVENUE TO LOCAL BODIES · UNION FINANCE COMMISSION · ARTICLE 280(3)(BB) PANCHAYATS; ARTICLE 280(3)(C) MUNICIPALITIES · TIED AGAINST UNTIED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
OWN REVENUE → property tax and local levies; narrow base, outdated valuation	UNION FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280(3)(bb) Panchayats; Article 280(3)(c) Municipalities	OWN REVENUE → property tax and local levies; narrow base, outdated valuation
STATE FINANCE COMMISSION → recommends devolution of State revenue to local bodies	TIED AGAINST UNTIED → tied grants convert a planning authority into an executing agency	STATE FINANCE COMMISSION → recommends devolution of State revenue to local bodies

CORE CLAIM
- OWN REVENUE → property tax and local levies; narrow base, outdated valuation
- STATE FINANCE COMMISSION → recommends devolution of State revenue to local bodies

MECHANISM
- UNION FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280(3)(bb) Panchayats; Article 280(3)(c) Municipalities
- TIED AGAINST UNTIED → tied grants convert a planning authority into an executing agency

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- OWN REVENUE → property tax and local levies; narrow base, outdated valuation
- STATE FINANCE COMMISSION → recommends devolution of State revenue to local bodies

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TIED AGAINST UNTIED → tied grants convert a planning authority into an executing agency.

04

STAGE 04 — PLANNING INSTITUTIONS

PLANNING INSTITUTIONS · DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE · ARTICLE 243ZD: CONSOLIDATES PANCHAYAT AND MUNICIPALITY PLANS · COMPOSITION RULE · AT LEAST FOUR-FIFTHS ELECTED BY AND FROM THE DISTRICT'S · SEATS IN PROPORTION TO THE RURAL AND URBAN POPULATION · METROPOLITAN PLANNING COMMITTEE · ARTICLE 243ZE: DRAFT DEVELOPMENT PLAN FOR THE METRO AREA

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans	PROPORTION → seats in proportion to the rural and urban population of the district	SHARED LIMIT → constitution and effectiveness are State-variable; no compliance count
COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members	METROPOLITAN PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZE; draft development plan for the metro area	DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans

CORE CLAIM
- DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans
- COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members

MECHANISM
- PROPORTION → seats in proportion to the rural and urban population of the district
- METROPOLITAN PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZE; draft development plan for the metro area

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- SHARED LIMIT → constitution and effectiveness are State-variable; no compliance count
- DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members.

05

STAGE 05 — SCHEDULED AREAS PRECISION

SCHEDULED AREAS PRECISION · THE PANCHAYATS EXTENSION TO SCHEDULED AREAS ACT, 1996 · APPLIES TO · FIFTH SCHEDULE AREAS, NOT TO EVERY TRIBAL-MAJORITY AREA · GRAM SABHA · POWERS OVER LOCAL PLANS, RESOURCES AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION · EXACT LIMIT · CONSULTATION BEFORE LAND ACQUISITION AND RESETTLEMENT, NOT CONSENT

STATUTE → the Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996 → APPLIES TO → Fifth Schedule areas, not to every tribal-majority area → GRAM SABHA → powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution → EXACT LIMIT → consultation before land acquisition and resettlement, not consent → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Eleventh and Twelfth Schedule subjects are not self-executing

CORE CLAIM
- STATUTE → the Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996
- APPLIES TO → Fifth Schedule areas, not to every tribal-majority area

MECHANISM
- GRAM SABHA → powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution
- EXACT LIMIT → consultation before land acquisition and resettlement, not consent

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Eleventh and Twelfth Schedule subjects are not self-executing...
- STATUTE → the Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Eleventh and Twelfth Schedule subjects are not self-executing.

06

STAGE 06 — THREE DEGREES OF DECENTRALISATION

THREE DEGREES OF DECENTRALISATION · FIELD OFFICES OF A HIGHER TIER OPERATING LOCALLY · AGENCY FUNCTIONS PERFORMED ON BEHALF OF A HIGHER TIER · TRANSFER OF AUTHORITY TOGETHER WITH RESOURCES AND ACCOUNTABILITY · MOST INDIAN PRACTICE SITS BETWEEN THE FIRST TWO · DECONCENTRATION → field offices of a higher tier operating locally

DELEGATION → agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier → DEVOLUTION → transfer of authority together with resources and accountability → FINDING → most Indian practice sits between the first two

CORE CLAIM
- DECONCENTRATION → field offices of a higher tier operating locally
- DELEGATION → agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier

MECHANISM
- DEVOLUTION → transfer of authority together with resources and accountability
- FINDING → most Indian practice sits between the first two

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DECONCENTRATION → field offices of a higher tier operating locally
- DELEGATION → agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FINDING → most Indian practice sits between the first two.

07

STAGE 07 — DEVOLUTION CHAIN TO SERVICE OUTCOME

DEVOLUTION CHAIN TO SERVICE OUTCOME · CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION · A PERMANENT THIRD TIER IS ESTABLISHED · STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING · STATES DIVERGE SHARPLY AT THIS STAGE · FUND DESIGN · OWN REVENUE, COMMISSION DEVOLUTION, TIED AGAINST UNTIED GRANTS · FUNCTIONARY CONTROL

CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION → a permanent third tier is established → STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING: States diverge sharply at this stage → FUND DESIGN: own revenue, commission devolution, tied against untied grants → FUNCTIONARY CONTROL: whose career does the field officer actually depend on → CAPACITY, then INTERNAL ACCOUNTABILITY: assembly, ward committee, local audit

CORE CLAIM
- CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION → a permanent third tier is established
- STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING: States diverge sharply at this stage

MECHANISM
- FUND DESIGN: own revenue, commission devolution, tied against untied grants
- FUNCTIONARY CONTROL: whose career does the field officer actually depend on

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CAPACITY, then INTERNAL ACCOUNTABILITY: assembly, ward committee, local audit
- SERVICE OUTCOME: water, sanitation, roads, streetlights, records, welfare

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SERVICE OUTCOME: water, sanitation, roads, streetlights, records, welfare.

08

STAGE 08 — MERGER BALANCE SHEET

MERGER BALANCE SHEET · UNIFIED PLANNING ACROSS A FUNCTIONALLY CONTINUOUS SETTLEMENT · SCALE ECONOMIES IN WATER, SANITATION, SOLID WASTE AND TRANSPORT · DILUTED RURAL REPRESENTATION AND DISRUPTED LOCAL REVENUE ARRANGEMENTS · GREATER ADMINISTRATIVE DISTANCE AND LOSS OF THE VILLAGE ASSEMBLY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FOR → unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement	AGAINST → diluted rural representation and disrupted local revenue arrangements	FOR → unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement
FOR → scale economies in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport	AGAINST → greater administrative distance and loss of the village assembly forum	FOR → scale economies in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport

CORE CLAIM
- FOR → unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement
- FOR → scale economies in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport

MECHANISM
- AGAINST → diluted rural representation and disrupted local revenue arrangements
- AGAINST → greater administrative distance and loss of the village assembly forum

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FOR → unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement
- FOR → scale economies in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AGAINST → greater administrative distance and loss of the village assembly forum.

09

STAGE 09 — DECISION RULE FOR RECLASSIFICATION

DECISION RULE FOR RECLASSIFICATION · CRITERION 1 · POPULATION DENSITY TRAJECTORY AND NON-AGRICULTURAL EMPLOYMENT SHARE · CRITERION 2 · INFRASTRUCTURE-SHARING POTENTIAL AND TERRITORIAL CONTIGUITY · CRITERION 3 · REVENUE-BASE COMPATIBILITY AND CAPACITY OF THE RECEIVING BODY · MIDDLE OPTIONS · CRITERION 1 → population density trajectory and non-agricultural employment share

CRITERION 2 → infrastructure-sharing potential and territorial contiguity → CRITERION 3 → revenue-base compatibility and capacity of the receiving body → MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities

CORE CLAIM
- CRITERION 1 → population density trajectory and non-agricultural employment share
- CRITERION 2 → infrastructure-sharing potential and territorial contiguity

MECHANISM
- CRITERION 3 → revenue-base compatibility and capacity of the receiving body
- MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CRITERION 1 → population density trajectory and non-agricultural employment share
- CRITERION 2 → infrastructure-sharing potential and territorial contiguity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities.

10

STAGE 10 — URBAN FRAGMENTATION MAP

URBAN FRAGMENTATION MAP · POLITICAL LEADERSHIP · MAYOR AND COUNCIL UNDER STATE LAW · EXECUTIVE CONTROL · A STATE-APPOINTED MUNICIPAL COMMISSIONER IN MANY STATES · FUNCTIONS AND BUDGETS · DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITIES AND WATER, TRANSPORT, HOUSING AGENCIES · CONSTRAINED PROPERTY TAX; MUNICIPAL BONDS ONLY FOR STRONGER BODIES

POLITICAL LEADERSHIP → Mayor and council under State law → EXECUTIVE CONTROL → a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner in many States → FUNCTIONS AND BUDGETS → development authorities and water, transport, housing agencies → FINANCE → constrained property tax; municipal bonds only for stronger bodies → CONSEQUENCE → responsibility without matching authority at the elected tier

CORE CLAIM
- POLITICAL LEADERSHIP → Mayor and council under State law
- EXECUTIVE CONTROL → a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner in many States

MECHANISM
- FUNCTIONS AND BUDGETS → development authorities and water, transport, housing agencies
- FINANCE → constrained property tax; municipal bonds only for stronger bodies

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CONSEQUENCE → responsibility without matching authority at the elected tier
- POLITICAL LEADERSHIP → Mayor and council under State law

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSEQUENCE → responsibility without matching authority at the elected tier.

11

STAGE 11 — ANSWER SPINE FOR A LOCAL-GOVERNANCE DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A LOCAL-GOVERNANCE DEMAND · THE THREE LEGS, NOT THE AMENDMENT; DELIVERY CAPACITY, NOT · TRACE ONE SERVICE FROM LISTED SUBJECT TO WORK ORDER · LABEL ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES SEPARATELY AND GIVE A CRITERIA-BASED · GRADED VERDICT ON REPRESENTATION AGAINST AUTHORITY WITH STATE VARIATION · EVIDENCE LIMIT · USE KERALA PLANNING, MUNICIPAL SANITATION

OPEN → the three legs, not the amendment; delivery capacity, not constitutional recital → BUILD → trace one service from listed subject to work order and name where it → CORRECT → label advantages and disadvantages separately and give a criteria-based rule → CLOSE → graded verdict on representation against authority with State variation stated → EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Kerala planning, municipal sanitation

CORE CLAIM
- OPEN → the three legs, not the amendment; delivery capacity, not constitutional recital
- BUILD → trace one service from listed subject to work order and name where it stops

MECHANISM
- CORRECT → label advantages and disadvantages separately and give a criteria-based rule
- CLOSE → graded verdict on representation against authority with State variation stated

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Kerala planning, municipal sanitation,...
- OPEN → the three legs, not the amendment; delivery capacity, not constitutional recital

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict on representation against authority with State variation stated.

E

EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · RURAL-URBAN MERGER DECISIONS ARE BEST EVALUATED USING EXPLICIT CRITERIA · THE DEVOLUTION-GAP DIAGNOSTIC ALSO EXPLAINS WHY INDIA'S GOOD GOVERNANCE · FUNCTIONARY-CONTROL GAPS INTERSECT WITH THE CIVIL-SERVICES GENERALIST-SPECIALIST DEBATE · DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEES ARE THE CONSTITUTIONALLY MANDATED CONSOLIDATION MECHANISM · ARTICLE 243ZD'S FOUR-FIFTHS ELECTED-MEMBER RULE AND COMMON-INTEREST PLANNING FACTORS · THE MINISTRY OF PANCHAYATI RAJ DEVOLUTION INDEX REPORT 2024 · STATE FINANCE COMMISSIONS ARE THE CONSTITUTIONALLY MANDATED MECHANISM (COMPOSITION/

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: Rural-urban merger decisions are best evaluated using explicit criteria — population
- CAUTION: The devolution-gap diagnostic also explains why India's Good Governance Index (01)
- CAUTION: Functionary-control gaps intersect with the civil-services generalist-specialist debate
- District Planning Committees are the constitutionally mandated consolidation mechanism

ADVANCED DEBATE
- Article 243ZD's four-fifths elected-member rule and common-interest planning factors make
- The Ministry of Panchayati Raj Devolution Index Report 2024 provides a current,
- State Finance Commissions are the constitutionally mandated mechanism (composition/
- CAUTION: Kerala's continuing institutional practice (post-1996) of protecting the devolved plan

LEGACY / NUANCE
- CAUTION: A rapidly urbanising Gram Panchayat on a metropolitan periphery facing traffic, water and
- CAUTION: Boundary case: a demographically still-agrarian Gram Panchayat with a distinct local
- CAUTION: Parastatal water-board control persisting despite formal devolution of water supply to
- CAUTION: Full 3F devolution (Kerala-style) requires sustained political commitment across

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels